Himaayah Schools
MADRASAH

GUIDE

وَأَزْوَاجُهُۥٓ أُمَّهَٰتُهُمْ

"...and his wives are their mothers." (al-Aḥzāb 33:6)

The Mothers of the Believers

The lives of the eleven wives of the Prophet ﷺ: their stories, their virtues, and what they gave the Ummah.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Allah gave the wives of the Prophet ﷺ a title no other women share: **Ummahāt al-Muʾminīn**, the Mothers of the Believers.

> النَّبِيُّ أَوْلَىٰ بِالْمُؤْمِنِينَ مِنْ أَنفُسِهِمْ ۖ وَأَزْوَاجُهُ أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ
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> **“The Prophet is closer to the believers than their own selves, and his wives are their mothers.”**
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> Al-Aḥzāb 33:6.

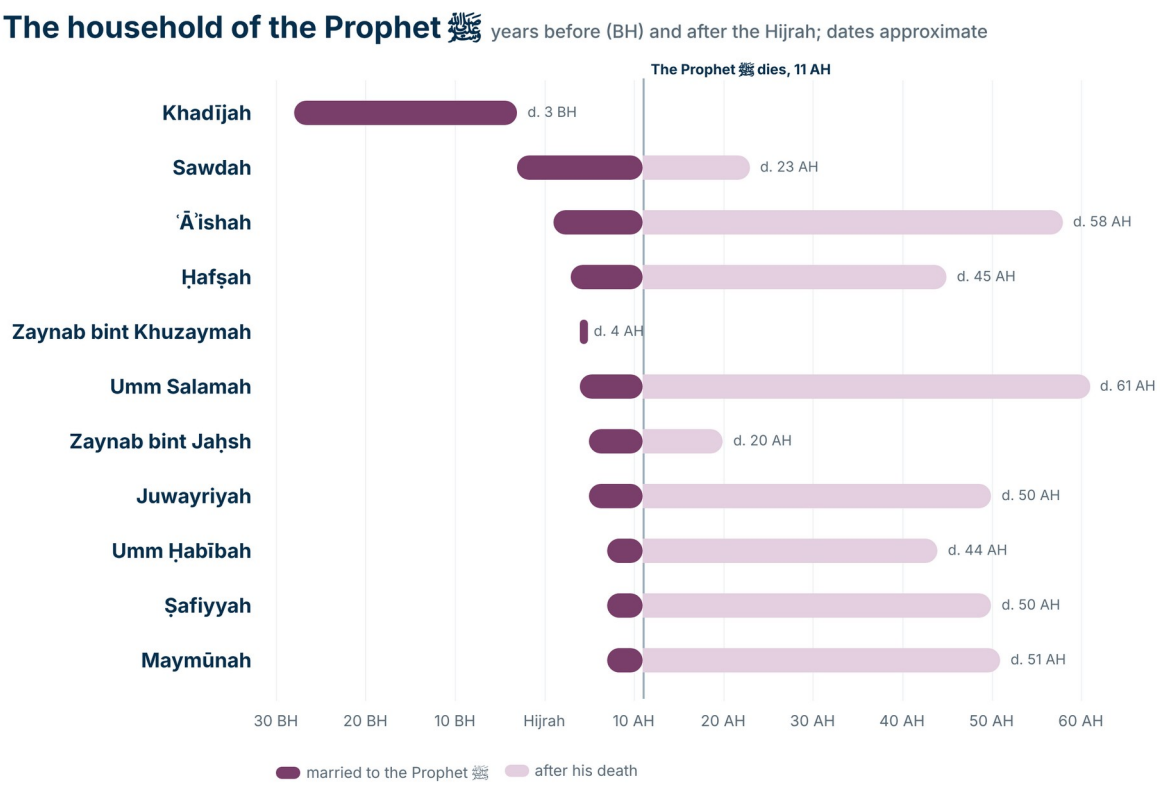
They are our mothers in **honour and respect**: every Muslim must love them, speak of them with reverence and defend their honour. After the Prophet ﷺ died, it was not lawful for anyone to marry them (al-Aḥzāb 33:53). Allah addressed them directly in the Qur’an, gave them the choice between this world and Allah and His Messenger, and they all chose Allah and His Messenger (al-Aḥzāb 33:28–29; al-Bukhārī 4785). And He said of them: “Allah only intends to remove impurity from you, O people of the household, and to purify you completely” (33:33).

Through them, the Ummah learned how the Prophet ﷺ lived at home: how he prayed at night, how he treated his family, how he spent his day, and much of what concerns the lives of women. ʿĀʾishah alone narrated more than two thousand ḥadīth, and Umm Salamah several hundred.

How this book tells their stories

The stories are taken from the **Qur’an**, the **authentic ḥadīth** (with the source given), and the **books of sīrah**, such as Ibn Saʿd’s Ṭabaqāt. Dates of marriage and death are approximate, and the reports sometimes differ; the best-known view is given.

There were eleven wives with whom the marriage was completed, and they are counted here in the order he married them. Māriyah al-Qibṭiyyah, the mother of his son Ibrāhīm, is mentioned at the end.



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Part 1 Why the Prophet ﷺ married more than one wife

Some people ask why the Prophet ﷺ had several wives. The facts of his life answer much of the question:

- From the age of **25 to about 50**, he was married to **one wife**, Khadījah, who was fifteen years older than him, and he married no one else while she lived.
- All his later marriages took place in his **fifties**, in the busiest and hardest years of his mission. All but one of his wives, ʿĀʾishah, had been married before; most were **widows**, several of them older women.
- Allah gave him a special permission in this, which is not for the rest of the Ummah (al-Aḥzāb 33:50). Other Muslims may marry up to four, with justice (an-Nisāʾ 4:3).

The wisdom the scholars mention

Wisdom	Examples
Caring for widows of martyrs and emigrants	Sawdah, Ḥafṣah, Zaynab bint Khuzaymah, Umm Salamah and Umm Ḥabībah had lost their husbands in the path of Allah or in exile.
Binding the Ummah together	Marrying the daughters of Abū Bakr and ʿUmar honoured his two closest Companions. His marriages to Juwayriyah, Umm Ḥabībah and Ṣafiyyah brought whole tribes and families closer to Islām.
Teaching the Ummah	His wives transmitted what happened inside the home: his worship at night, his character with his family, and rulings that concern women, which men could not easily have reported.
Making laws clear	His marriage to Zaynab bint Jaḥsh, the former wife of his adopted son Zayd, ended a custom of the Jāhiliyyah by command of Allah (al-Aḥzāb 33:37).
Mercy and honour	Ṣafiyyah and Juwayriyah, daughters of chiefs who were taken captive, were freed and honoured as wives rather than left as captives.

The Prophet ﷺ was perfectly just between his wives in time, provision and housing, giving each one her day and night, and when he travelled he drew lots to choose who would go with him (al-Bukhārī, 2593). He said: “The best of you are the best to their families, and I am the best of you to my family” (at-Tirmidhī, 3895).

Mother 1 Khadījah bint Khuwaylid

خَدِيجَةُ بِنْتُ خُوَيْلِدٍ

Of Banū Asad of Quraysh

Lineage

Title	aṭ-Ṭāhirah, “the pure”, before Islām
Married	About 15 years before Prophethood; he was 25
Children	al-Qāsim, Zaynab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthūm, Fāṭimah and ʿAbdullāh
Died	In Makkah, about three years before the Hijrah, in the Year of Sorrow; buried in al-Ḥajūn

Khadījah was a noble, intelligent and wealthy merchant of Quraysh, a widow who had refused many proposals. She hired the young Muḥammad ﷺ to trade for her, and was so struck by his honesty and character that she proposed marriage to him. For twenty-five years she was his only wife, and the mother of all his children but one.

When the first revelation came and he returned from Ḥirāʾ trembling, she covered him, calmed him and said: “By Allah, Allah will never disgrace you. You keep the ties of kinship, carry the burdens of the weak, give to the destitute, honour the guest and help those struck by calamity” (al-Bukhārī, 3). She took him to Waraqah ibn Nawfal and became the **first person to believe** in him. She spent her wealth on the cause of Islām and went with him into the three years of boycott in the valley, though she was an old woman by then. She died soon after it ended.

Her virtues

- “The best of its women is Maryam bint ʿImrān, and the best of its women is Khadījah” (al-Bukhārī 3432, Muslim 2430).
- Jibrīl came and said: “Khadījah is coming with a vessel of food. When she comes, convey to her the greeting of her Lord and of me, and give her glad tidings of a house in Paradise of hollowed pearl, in which there is no noise and no fatigue” (al-Bukhārī 3820, Muslim 2432).
- He never stopped remembering her. He would slaughter a sheep and send portions to her friends. ʿĀʾishah said: “I was never jealous of any woman as I was of Khadījah, though I never saw her” (al-Bukhārī, 3818). He said: “I was blessed with her love” (Muslim, 2435).

Lessons from her life

- A wife’s support can carry a husband through his hardest days.
- Use your wealth for the truth.
- Faithfulness does not end with death: he honoured her memory for the rest of his life.

Mother 2 Sawdah bint Zamʿah

سَوْدَةُ بِنْتُ زَمْعَةَ

Of Banū ʿĀmir ibn Luʾayy of Quraysh

Lineage

First husband	As-Sakrān ibn ʿAmr; they emigrated to Abyssinia together, and he died after their return
Married	In Makkah, after the death of Khadījah, about three years before the Hijrah
Died	In Madinah, most say at the end of the caliphate of ʿUmar

Sawdah was among the early Muslims, and endured the hardship of the hijrah to Abyssinia. After the death of Khadījah, when the Prophet ﷺ was left with young daughters to care for, he married Sawdah, an older widow, and she cared for his household in the hardest years. She was tall, generous and good-humoured, and she could make the Prophet ﷺ laugh.

As she grew older, she gave her day with the Prophet ﷺ to ʿĀʾishah, out of love for his happiness and hoping to remain his wife in this world and the next (al-Bukhārī 5212, Muslim 1463). ʿĀʾishah said: “There is no woman I would rather be in her skin than Sawdah” (Muslim, 1463). At the Farewell Ḥajj, she asked permission to leave Muzdalifah before the crowd, being a heavy, slow woman, and he gave it to her (al-Bukhārī, 1680).

Lessons from her life

- Generosity and selflessness within the family.
- Cheerfulness is a virtue; the Prophet ﷺ enjoyed her humour.
- She stood with Islām in its weakest days, in Makkah and Abyssinia.

Mother 3 ʿĀʾishah bint Abī Bakr

عَائِشَةُ بِنْتُ أَبِي بَكْرٍ الصِّدِّيقِ

Daughter of Abū Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddīq and Umm Rūmān

Lineage

Kunyah	Umm ʿAbdillāh, after her nephew ʿAbdullāh ibn az-Zubayr
Married	The contract in Makkah; she joined his household in Madinah in the first or second year after the Hijrah
Ḥadīth	More than 2,200 narrations: the most of any woman, and among the most of all the Companions
Died	In Madinah in Ramaḍān, 57 or 58 AH; buried in al-Baqīʿ

ʿĀʾishah was the only virgin the Prophet ﷺ married (al-Bukhārī, 5077). Before the marriage, he saw her in a dream, brought to him by an angel in a piece of silk: "If this is from Allah, He will bring it about" (al-Bukhārī 3895, Muslim 2438). She grew up in his house and became the greatest woman scholar of the Ummah. When ʿAmr ibn al-ʿĀṣ asked him who was the most beloved of people to him, he said: "ʿĀʾishah." "And of men?" "Her father" (al-Bukhārī, 3662).

Her virtues

- "The superiority of ʿĀʾishah over other women is like the superiority of tharīd over other food" (al-Bukhārī 3770, Muslim 2446).
- Jibrīl sent her his greeting of peace (al-Bukhārī 3768, Muslim 2447). And revelation came to the Prophet ﷺ while he was under her blanket, which happened with no other wife (al-Bukhārī, 3775).
- Because she lost her necklace on a journey, and the army stopped where there was no water, Allah revealed the verse of **tayammum**. Usayd ibn Ḥuḍayr said: "This is not the first of your blessings, O family of Abū Bakr" (al-Bukhārī, 334).
- When the hypocrites slandered her, Allah revealed her innocence in **Sūrat an-Nūr** (24:11–26), verses that will be recited until the Last Day (al-Bukhārī, 4141).
- The Prophet ﷺ died with his head on her chest, in her house, on her day, and was buried in her room (al-Bukhārī 4450, 4451).
- The great Companions came to her with their questions. Abū Mūsā said: "Whenever a ḥadīth was unclear to us, the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, we asked ʿĀʾishah, and found that she had knowledge of it" (at-Tirmidhī, 3883).

For students

Her age at marriage. Al-Bukhārī (3894, 5133) and Muslim (1422) report from ʿĀʾishah herself that the contract was made when she was six and she joined his household when she was nine. In that time and place, marriage at a young age after maturity was the custom of every people, and none of the Prophet's ﷺ enemies, who searched for every fault, ever objected to it. Some modern writers have argued from other reports that she was older; the scholars of ḥadīth have held to what is in the two Ṣaḥīḥs.

What matters most is what came from this marriage: a woman who understood the Qur'an and Sunnah so deeply that the senior Companions learned from her for half a century.

Lessons from her life

- Knowledge is for women as much as for men: she was a teacher of the Companions.
- Patience and trust in Allah under false accusation.
- Love and play within marriage: he raced with her, and let her watch the Abyssinians play in the masjid (Abū Dāwūd 2578; al-Bukhārī 454).

Mother 4 Ḥafṣah bint ʿUmar

حَفْصَةُ بِنْتُ عُمَرَ بْنِ الْخَطَّابِ

Daughter of ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb

Lineage

First husband	Khunays ibn Ḥudhāfah, a Companion of Badr, who died in Madinah of his wounds
Married	About 3 AH
Died	In Madinah, about 45 AH (some say 41)

When Ḥafṣah was widowed, her father ʿUmar offered her in marriage to ʿUthmān, who declined, and then to Abū Bakr, who said nothing. ʿUmar was hurt. A few days later the Prophet ﷺ proposed to her himself. Abū Bakr then explained to ʿUmar that he had known the Prophet ﷺ had mentioned her, and would not reveal his secret; had the Prophet ﷺ left her, he would have accepted (al-Bukhārī, 4005).

She was known for much fasting and prayer at night. Like her father, she was strong-willed and spoke her mind. She was among the few who could read and write, and she was chosen to keep **the sheets of the Qur'an** that Abū Bakr had gathered. They passed from Abū Bakr to ʿUmar, and then to her, and from her copy ʿUthmān had the standard muṣḥafs written that were sent to every land (al-Bukhārī, 4986–4987).

Lessons from her life

- A trust kept for the whole Ummah: the Qur'an in our hands passed through her care.
- Fathers may seek good husbands for their daughters, as ʿUmar did.
- Keeping a secret, as Abū Bakr did, is part of loyalty.

Mother 5 Zaynab bint Khuzaymah

زَيْنَبُ بِنْتُ خُزَيْمَةَ

Of Banū ʿĀmir ibn Ṣaʿṣaʿah

Lineage

Title	Umm al-Masākīn, "the mother of the poor"
Married	About 4 AH, after her husband was martyred
Died	A few months after the marriage, in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime; buried in al-Baqīʿ

Zaynab was known even before Islām as **the mother of the poor**, because of how much she fed and gave to them. Her husband was martyred (the reports differ on whether at Badr or Uḥud), and the Prophet ﷺ married her to honour and care for her. She lived only a few months more. Apart from Khadījah, she was the only one of his wives to die in his lifetime, and he prayed over her himself.

Lessons from her life

- A name earned by deeds: generosity to the poor can define a whole life.
- Caring for the widows of those who gave their lives for Islām.

Mother 6 Umm Salamah: Hind bint Abī Umayyah

أُمُّ سَلَمَةَ هِنْدُ بِنْتُ أَبِي أُمَيَّةَ

Of Banū Makhzūm of Quraysh; her father was famous for his generosity

Lineage

First husband	Abū Salamah ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbd al-Asad, the Prophet's ﷺ foster-brother, who died of a wound from Uḥud
Married	About 4 AH
Died	In Madinah about 61 AH, the last of the Mothers of the Believers to die

Umm Salamah and her husband were among the first Muslims and the first emigrants to Abyssinia. The sīrah books tell the moving story of their hijrah to Madinah: her family took her from her husband, his family took their son from her, and for about a year she went out every day and wept, until her family relented and she travelled alone with her child to Madinah.

When Abū Salamah died, she remembered what the Prophet ﷺ had taught: that whoever is struck by a calamity and says "We belong to Allah and to Him we return. O Allah, reward me in my calamity and replace it for me with something better," Allah will replace it with something better. She said it, thinking: "Who could be better than Abū Salamah?" And Allah gave her the Messenger of Allah ﷺ (Muslim, 918).

> إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ، اللَّهُمَّ أْجُرْنِي فِي مُصِيبَتِي وَأَخْلِفْ لِي خَيْرًا مِنْهَا
>
> **"We belong to Allah and to Him we return. O Allah, reward me in my calamity and replace it for me with something better."**
>
> Muslim (918), narrated by Umm Salamah.

She was wise, beautiful and eloquent. At al-Ḥudaybiyah, when the Companions were too heartbroken to obey the command to sacrifice and shave, it was her advice that resolved the crisis: "Go out, speak to no one, sacrifice your camel and call your barber." He did, and they all followed (al-Bukhārī, 2731). She narrated several hundred ḥadīth and gave fatwā to the people of Madinah for decades.

Lessons from her life

- Say the duʿāʾ of calamity, and trust that Allah will replace what you lost.
- Wise counsel from a woman saved the day at al-Ḥudaybiyah.
- Sacrifice for the hijrah: she was separated from her husband and child for the sake of Allah.

Mother 7 Zaynab bint Jaḥsh

زَيْنَبُ بِنْتُ جَحْشٍ

Of Banū Asad ibn Khuzaymah; her mother Umaymah was the Prophet's ﷺ aunt, the daughter of ʿAbd al-Muṭṭalib

Lineage

First husband	Zayd ibn Ḥārithah, the Prophet's ﷺ freed slave and adopted son
Married	About 5 AH
Died	In Madinah in 20 AH, the first of his wives to die after him

Zaynab was the Prophet's ﷺ cousin, from a noble family. At his request she married **Zayd ibn Ḥārithah**, his freed slave and adopted son, to show that in Islām nobility is by taqwā, not lineage. The marriage was not happy and ended in divorce. Then Allah Himself commanded the Prophet ﷺ to marry her, to end the Jāhiliyyah custom that treated an adopted son like a son by birth (al-Aḥzāb 33:37). Zaynab used to tell the other wives with pride: "Your families married you off, but Allah married me from above the seven heavens" (al-Bukhārī, 7420). The verse of ḥijāb was revealed on the day of her wedding feast (al-Bukhārī, 4791).

She was famous for her devotion and her charity. She worked with her own hands, tanning and sewing, and gave the earnings away. The Prophet ﷺ said to his wives: "The first of you to join me will be the one with the longest hand." They measured their hands; but when Zaynab died first, they understood that he meant the most generous in giving (Muslim, 2452). ʿĀ'ishah, who said Zaynab was the one who used to compete with her in rank, also said: "I have never seen a woman better in religion than Zaynab, more God-fearing, more truthful, more mindful of the ties of kinship, or more charitable" (Muslim, 2442). During the slander, when she could have spoken against her rival, she said: "I protect my hearing and my sight; I know nothing of her but good" (al-Bukhārī, 4141).

Lessons from her life

- Earn with your hands and give in charity.
- Honesty even about a rival: she defended ʿĀ'ishah.
- Islām judges people by taqwā, not by lineage.

Mother 8 Juwayriyah bint al-Ḥārith

جُوَيْرِيَةُ بِنْتُ الْحَارِثِ

Daughter of al-Ḥārith ibn Abī Ḍirār, chief of Banū al-Muṣṭaliq of Khuzāʿah

Lineage

Married	About 5 AH (or 6), after the expedition of Banū al-Muṣṭaliq
Died	In Madinah, about 50 AH

Juwayriyah was taken captive when her tribe was defeated at al-Muraysīʿ. She came to the Prophet ﷺ to ask for help in buying her freedom. He offered to pay it and marry her, and she accepted. When the Companions heard, they said: "They are the in-laws of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ," and freed all the captives of her people they held, about a hundred families. ʿĀʾishah said: "I do not know any woman who was a greater blessing to her people than she" (Abū Dāwūd, 3931). Her people entered Islām.

She was devoted to dhikr. One morning the Prophet ﷺ left her sitting in her place of prayer after Fajr, and returned in the late morning to find her still there. He said: "I said four phrases after leaving you, three times; if they were weighed against all you have said since this morning, they would outweigh it" (Muslim, 2726):

سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ وَبِحَمْدِهِ، عَدَدَ خَلْقِهِ، وَرِضَا نَفْسِهِ، وَزِنَةَ عَرْشِهِ، وَمِدَادَ كَلِمَاتِهِ

"Glory be to Allah and praise be to Him, as many times as the number of His creation, as much as pleases Him, as much as the weight of His Throne, and as much as the ink of His words."

Muslim (2726), narrated by Juwayriyah.

Lessons from her life

- One person can be a blessing for a whole people.
- Love dhikr, and learn the words that weigh most.

Mother 9 Umm Ḥabībah: Ramlah bint Abī Sufyān

أُمُّ حَبِيبَةَ رَمْلَةُ بِنْتُ أَبِي سُفْيَانَ

Daughter of Abū Sufyān, leader of Quraysh, and sister of Muʿāwiyah

Lineage

First husband	ʿUbaydullāh ibn Jaḥsh, with whom she emigrated to Abyssinia, and who left Islām there
Married	By proxy in Abyssinia, about 6–7 AH
Died	In Madinah, about 44 AH

Umm Ḥabībah accepted Islām in Makkah against the will of her father, the chief enemy of the Muslims, and emigrated with her husband to Abyssinia. There, the sīrah books report, her husband became a Christian and died, leaving her alone in a foreign land, cut off from her family. The Prophet ﷺ sent to the Najāshī asking for her hand. The Najāshī conducted the marriage on his behalf and gave her a dowry of four hundred dinars from himself (Abū Dāwūd, 2107), and she came to Madinah.

Her loyalty to Allah and His Messenger was above her loyalty to her father. The sīrah books tell how, when Abū Sufyān came to Madinah before the Opening of Makkah, she folded away the Prophet's ﷺ bedding so that he would not sit on it, saying: "It is the bed of the Messenger of Allah, and you are an idolater." She narrated the virtue of the twelve sunnah prayers: "Whoever prays twelve rakʿahs in a day and night, a house will be built for him in Paradise" (Muslim, 728); she said she never left them after hearing it.

Lessons from her life

- Holding to Islām when family and husband turn away.
- Allah does not abandon the one who is alone for His sake.
- Hear a virtue, act on it for life: the twelve rakʿahs.

Mother 10 Ṣafiyyah bint Ḥuyayy

صَفِيَّةُ بِنْتُ حُيَيِّ بْنِ أَخْطَبَ

Daughter of Ḥuyayy ibn Akhṭab, chief of Banū an-Naḍīr, descended from Hārūn, the brother of Mūsā

Lineage

Married	In 7 AH, after Khaybar
Died	In Madinah, about 50 AH

Ṣafiyyah was the daughter of the chief of Banū an-Naḍīr, one of the leaders who had gathered the confederates against Madinah. She was taken captive at Khaybar. The Prophet ﷺ freed her and married her, and made her **freedom her dowry** (al-Bukhārī, 371). She accepted Islām and was a sincere believer.

Some of the other wives once hurt her by calling her “the daughter of a Jew”. She came to the Prophet ﷺ weeping, and he said: “You are the daughter of a prophet, your uncle is a prophet, and you are married to a prophet. What do they have to boast over you?” (at-Tirmidhī, 3894), meaning Hārūn and Mūsā. When she visited him during his iʿtikāf in the masjid one night, he walked her back to her house himself (al-Bukhārī, 2035). In his final illness she said: “By Allah, O Prophet of Allah, I wish that what you have were in me,” and he said she was truthful (Ibn Saʿd).

Lessons from her life

- No one should be shamed for their family or origin: what counts is faith and taqwā.
- Kindness to a wife who has suffered: he comforted her and defended her.

Mother 11 Maymūnah bint al-Ḥārith

مَيْمُونَةُ بِنْتُ الْحَارِثِ

Of Banū Hilāl; sister of Umm al-Faḍl, the wife of al-ʿAbbās, and aunt of Ibn ʿAbbās and Khālid ibn al-Walīd

Lineage

Married	In 7 AH, at Sarif near Makkah, after ʿUmrat al-Qaḍāʾ; the last woman he married
Died	At Sarif, about 51 AH, and was buried where her marriage took place

Maymūnah was the last of his wives. He married her at Sarif, on the road between Makkah and Madinah, after the ʿumrah of 7 AH. She was known for her piety and for keeping the ties of kinship. Her nephew **Ibn ʿAbbās** spent nights in her house as a boy, and from there he described the Prophet’s ﷺ night prayer in detail: how he woke, recited the last verses of Āl ʿImrān, made wuḍūʾ and prayed (al-Bukhārī 138, 4569). Through her, part of the Prophet’s ﷺ private worship reached the Ummah. Many years later she died at Sarif and, at her request, was buried there.

Lessons from her life

- A family that opens its home to young learners: Ibn ʿAbbās became the scholar of the Ummah.
- Keep the ties of kinship.

Māriyah al-Qibṭiyyah

Māriyah was an Egyptian Christian sent as a gift to the Prophet ﷺ by al-Muqawqis, the ruler of Egypt, after the Prophet ﷺ wrote to him. She accepted Islām and bore him his son **Ibrāhīm** in 8 AH. Ibrāhīm died at about eighteen months. The Prophet ﷺ wept and said: “The eyes shed tears and the heart grieves, but we say only what pleases our Lord. We are saddened by your parting, O Ibrāhīm” (al-Bukhārī, 1303). That day the sun was eclipsed, and people said it was for Ibrāhīm’s

death; he corrected them: “The sun and moon do not eclipse for anyone’s death or life” (al-Bukhārī, 1043). Most scholars do not count her among the Mothers of the Believers, as she was not married to him by contract, but she is honoured as the mother of his son.

Lessons What the Mothers of the Believers teach us

Lessons for us

1	**Love and honour them.** Speaking ill of the Mothers of the Believers is speaking ill of the household of the Prophet ﷺ, whom Allah purified.
2	**Women of knowledge.** ʿĀʾishah and Umm Salamah taught the Companions; Ḥafṣah kept the Qur'an. Seeking knowledge is for women and men alike.
3	**Women of generosity**: Khadījah's wealth, Zaynab bint Khuzaymah's care for the poor, Zaynab bint Jaḥsh's charity from her own work.
4	**Women of patience**: Sawdah and Umm Ḥabībah in exile, Umm Salamah separated from her family, ʿĀʾishah under slander.
5	**A model home.** Justice, kindness, playfulness, consultation and worship in the Prophet's ﷺ household are an example for every Muslim family.

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. **Which verse calls the Prophet's ﷺ wives "their mothers"?**
   a) Al-Aḥzāb 33:6 b) An-Nūr 24:31 c) Al-Baqarah 2:221 d) An-Nisāʾ 4:1

2. **How many years was Khadījah his only wife?**
   a) 5 b) 10 c) About 25 d) 40

3. **Who gave her day with the Prophet ﷺ to ʿĀʾishah?**
   a) Ḥafṣah b) Sawdah c) Ṣafiyyah d) Maymūnah

4. **Which verse was revealed because ʿĀʾishah lost her necklace?**
   a) The verse of ḥijāb b) The verse of tayammum c) The verse of the choice d) Āyat al-Kursī

5. **Who kept the sheets of the Qur'an gathered by Abū Bakr?**
   a) ʿĀʾishah b) Umm Salamah c) Ḥafṣah d) Zaynab

6. **Who was called "the mother of the poor"?**
   a) Zaynab bint Khuzaymah b) Juwayriyah c) Sawdah d) Umm Ḥabībah

7. **Which duʿāʾ did Umm Salamah say when her husband died?**
   a) The duʿāʾ of travel b) Sayyid al-Istighfār c) The duʿāʾ of calamity d) The duʿāʾ of Yūnus

8. **Who said: "Allah married me from above the seven heavens"?**
   a) ʿĀʾishah b) Zaynab bint Jaḥsh c) Ṣafiyyah d) Khadījah

9. Whose marriage led to about a hundred families being freed?

a) Maymūnah b) Umm Salamah c) Ḥafṣah d) Juwayriyah

10. Who conducted Umm Ḥabībah's marriage in Abyssinia?

a) The Najāshī b) Jaʿfar c) Abū Sufyān d) ʿUthmān

11. The Prophet ﷺ told Ṣafiyyah that her ancestor was the prophet:

a) Ibrāhīm b) Hārūn c) Sulaymān d) Yaʿqūb

12. Whose nephew Ibn ʿAbbās described the Prophet's ﷺ night prayer from her house?

a) Maymūnah b) Sawdah c) Juwayriyah d) Ḥafṣah

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	a) Al-Aḥzāb 33:6	7	c) The duʿāʾ of calamity
2	c) About 25	8	b) Zaynab bint Jaḥsh
3	b) Sawdah	9	d) Juwayriyah
4	b) Tayammum	10	a) The Najāshī
5	c) Ḥafṣah	11	b) Hārūn
6	a) Zaynab bint Khuzaymah	12	a) Maymūnah

For further reading

- **Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī** and **Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim**, the chapters on the virtues of the Companions and of the wives of the Prophet ﷺ.
- **Aṭ-Ṭabaqāt al-Kubrā** of Ibn Saʿd, the volume on women.
- **Siyar Aʿlām an-Nubalāʾ** of adh-Dhahabī, the biographies of the Mothers of the Believers.
- Sūrat al-Aḥzāb, especially verses 28–34 and 50–59, with a good tafsīr.

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وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

"And my success is only through Allah." (Hūd 11:88)

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